

Getting Started with LedgerFlow

Your first-week guide to setting up invoicing and bookkeeping — from signup to your first paid invoice.

1. Create your account

Sign up with your email address or continue with Google. You'll be asked to verify your email before you can log in — check your inbox (and spam folder) for the confirmation link. Once verified, LedgerFlow will drop you straight into the setup wizard, which walks you through the next few steps automatically. You can always revisit any of these settings later from your account menu.

2. Set up your business profile

Head to Settings > Business Profile and fill in your legal business name, address, tax ID or VAT number, and logo. This information appears automatically on every invoice you send, so it's worth getting right the first time. If you operate as a sole proprietor or freelancer, you can use your own name and personal tax ID here — LedgerFlow doesn't require a registered company. You can also set your default currency and fiscal year start date, which affects how your reports are calculated.

3. Connect a bank account

Go to Banking > Connect Account and choose your bank from the list of supported institutions. LedgerFlow uses a secure, read-only connection, so it can see transactions but never move money without your say-so. Once connected, your recent transactions will sync automatically, which makes reconciling payments and expenses far less manual. If your bank isn't listed, you can import transactions via CSV instead — look for the 'Import manually' link on the same page.

4. Add your first client

Click Clients > Add Client and enter their name, email, billing address, and preferred currency. If you bill several people at the same company, you can add multiple contacts under one client profile. Any notes you add here — like payment terms or a preferred invoice format — will be remembered and applied automatically the next time you invoice that client, so it's worth spending an extra minute on this step.

5. Create your first invoice

From the Invoices tab, click New Invoice and select the client you just added. Add line items for your products or services, set your payment terms (e.g., due on receipt or net 30), and attach your logo if you haven't already. LedgerFlow will auto-generate a sequential invoice number, but you can customize the numbering format in Settings if you prefer something specific. Preview the invoice before sending to make sure everything looks right, then hit Send — your client receives it by email

with a link to view and pay it online.

6. Set up recurring billing (optional)

If you bill the same client on a regular schedule — weekly, monthly, or otherwise — open any invoice and toggle Make Recurring. Choose the frequency, start date, and end date (or leave it open-ended), and LedgerFlow will generate and send future invoices automatically. You'll get a notification before each one goes out, so you can review or edit it first if anything's changed.

7. Connect payment methods

Go to Settings > Payments to enable the ways clients can pay you directly through an invoice, such as card payments, ACH bank transfer, or a connected payment processor like Stripe or PayPal. Turning this on adds a Pay Now button to every invoice, which tends to get you paid faster than bank details alone. You can set different payment options per client if needed, and processing fees (if any) are shown clearly before you enable each method.

8. Explore your reports

Once you've got a few invoices and transactions in the system, visit the Reports tab to see your income, outstanding balances, and expenses at a glance. The Profit & Loss and Aged Receivables reports are the two most useful starting points — the first shows how your business is performing, and the second shows who owes you money and for how long. Reports update in real time and can be exported as PDF or CSV whenever you need them for taxes or a quick gut check.

Tips for New Users

- Turn on invoice reminders (Settings > Notifications) so LedgerFlow automatically nudges clients about upcoming or overdue payments — one less thing for you to chase manually.
- Use invoice templates if you offer a few standard services or packages; it turns a five-minute invoice into a thirty-second one.
- Reconcile your bank feed weekly rather than monthly. Small, regular check-ins catch mismatched transactions early and keep your books audit-ready.
- Double-check your tax settings before sending your first invoice, especially if you charge sales tax or VAT — this is much easier to fix before an invoice is sent than after.
- Back up client and invoice data periodically using the Export tool under Settings > Data, even though LedgerFlow stores everything securely in the cloud.
- If you're new to bookkeeping, start with just the Profit & Loss and Aged Receivables reports — they cover 90% of what a small business actually needs day to day.

Need help along the way? The in-app chat (bottom-right corner) connects you to LedgerFlow support during business hours, and our Help Center has step-by-step articles for everything covered above.